

DELHI

# | Anger Management

3.6

crore people are eligible to vote in Rajasthan's 200 Assembly constituencies in the coming polls.

What makes Margaret Alva angry? Quite a bit, actually. One of the favoured ones at the Congress headquarters, Alva was in charge of four high-profile states—Maharashtra, Punjab, Haryana and Mizoram. But clearly Alva wanted more. Her recent outburst alleging nepotism during ticket distribution in Karnataka incensed the party leadership, which has ruled out a probe. A miffed Alva then resigned as general secretary. Alva was upset that while her son Nivedith was denied a ticket in the Karnataka Assembly polls, tickets were being distributed to relatives of various other leaders. She also hinted that tickets were being sold. However, what she left unsaid is that recently her state rival S.M. Krishna was given a Rajya Sabha nomination, something that Alva had been hoping for, while another bete noir, R.V. Deshpande, has been made Karnataka PCC chief. Alva's target is the coterie of (male) general secretaries at the party headquarters who are now dismissing her outburst as a tantrum claiming that the denial to Nivedith was not a "moral" issue. Not too long ago, another powerful woman general secretary Ambika Soni was sidelined by her colleagues. Although the two did not get along, it seems that Alva would do well to learn from Soni's story. In the meantime her wrath continues to bubble over. *by Priya Sahgal*



ALVA HAS FALLEN OUT WITH THE PARTY LEADERSHIP

NARENDRA BISHT